CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 20: **Fire and Ice (First Flight Poem)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which reading is most plausible? 1

(a) they are geography
(b) they are myths
(c) fire and ice are metaphors for human passions
(d) they are literal weather

2. The speaker's reliability is established by: 1

(a) reference to his own experience **(b)** reference to history
(c) reference to law **(d)** reference to scripture

3. A suitable inference from the poem is that: 1

(a) human emotions have global consequences **(b)** nature is harmless
(c) wars are rare **(d)** poems are useless

4. The poem's inclusion of a second possibility shows: 1

(a) the poet's balanced judgement **(b)** laziness
(c) fear **(d)** indecision

5. The poem differs from a scientific theory because it: 1

(a) treats the end of the world as moral **(b)** predicts a date
(c) cites experiments **(d)** gives data

6. A critic could say the poem is pessimistic because: 1

(a) it is about weather **(b)** it praises fire
(c) it offers no remedy **(d)** it is too long

7. 'I hold with those who favour fire' employs: 1

(a) a scientific register **(b)** a legal register
(c) a colloquial register **(d)** a religious register

8. The ending leaves the reader: 1

(a) certain of ice **(b)** certain of fire
(c) to judge which emotion is worse **(d)** laughing

9. Another critic could say it is realistic because: 1

(a) it is short **(b)** it states a truth about emotions
(c) it uses rhyme **(d)** it has a title

10. The word 'suffice' implies: 1

(a) that fire is rare
(b) that ice is warm
(c) that destruction needs no more than hatred
(d) that hatred is weak

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How is the poem's structure a miniature argument? 2

12. Comment on the poem's use of abstract nouns. 2

13. Explain the irony in a poem that uses mild words for catastrophe. 2

14. Why might Frost leave the question unresolved? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. How does the poem exemplify Frost's belief in plain speech with deep meaning? 3

16. Analyse the interplay of form and content. 3

17. Write a precise paraphrase of the last two lines in prose. 3

OR

Evaluate the symbolism of ice as 'quiet' destruction. 3

18. What makes 'Fire and Ice' a good poem for discussion in class? 3

OR

Identify two features that make the poem a lyric. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Write an essay on how desire and hatred shape human history, using the poem as a starting point. 5

OR

Discuss whether the poem is more relevant today than when it was written. 5

20. Compare 'Fire and Ice' with 'Dust of Snow' in theme, tone and technique. 5

OR

Write a dialogue between two climate activists who read the poem. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND